17.2 Creating Razor views

In this section we'll look at how Razor views fit into the Razor Pages framework. You'll learn how to pass data from your page handlers to your Razor views and how you can use that data to generate dynamic HTML.

With ASP.NET Core, whenever you need to display an HTML response to the user, you should use a view to generate it. Although it's possible to directly generate a `string` from your page handlers, which will be rendered as HTML in the browser, this approach doesn't adhere to the MVC separation of concerns and will quickly leave you tearing your hair out.

NOTE Some middleware, such as the `WelcomePageMiddleware` you saw in chapter 4, may generate HTML responses without using a view, which can make sense in some situations. But your Razor Page and MVC controllers should always generate HTML using views.

Instead, by relying on Razor views to generate the response, you get access to a wide variety of features, as well as editor tooling to help. This section serves as a gentle introduction to Razor views, the things you can do with them, and the various ways you can pass data to them.

17.2.1 Razor views and code-behind

In this book you've already seen that Razor Pages typically consist of two files:

- The .cshtml file, commonly called the *Razor view*
- The .cshtml.cs file, commonly called the *code-behind*, which contains the `PageModel`

The Razor view contains the `@page` *directive*, which makes it a Razor Page, as you've seen previously. Without this directive, the Razor Pages framework